Search your folders by what is in them

Files brings DigUp's file search into Ask. You choose folders; LokalBot reads the pictures, screenshots, PDFs and documents in them on this Mac, and Ask, Quick Recall and the Ask assistant can then find a file by what it says or shows, not only by its name. The same image model also lets screen search find a captured screen by what it showed (page 5).

"the clause about pets in the lease" → the PDF, opened at page 4

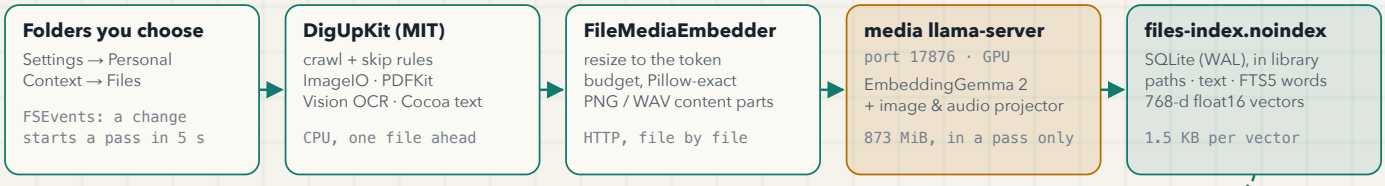
"payment declined error" → the screenshot

"a dog on the beach" → the photo

"where they talk about sleep" → the podcast, playing at 12:34

"INV-2041" → the invoice, by its exact words

INDEXING · IN THE BACKGROUND, ONLY WHILE FILES ARE NEW OR CHANGED



reads the index

SEARCH · AS YOU TYPE IN ASK AND QUICK RECALL, AND THE ASSISTANT'S search_files



One model, two servers.
Both run the same EmbeddingGemma 2 file LokalBot already uses for search by meaning (same revision, same SHA-256). Only the indexing server loads the 555 MB image and audio projector. Their text vectors are identical (cosine 1.000000), so a query from the small server scores pictures and PDF pages directly, and searching never loads the projector.

TAKEN FROM DIGUP

- The engine, `DigUpKit`, pinned by commit: crawler, skip rules, readers, index, search.
- Its image sizing, ported to Swift: matches Pillow bit for bit.
- Its ranking: meaning per modality plus exact words.

ADDED BY LOKALBOT

- An embedder that talks to LokalBot's own llama-server, not DigUp's llama.cpp build.
- Ask, Quick Recall, the assistant's tool and `[file:ID]` citations.
- Moments play in a LokalBot window; the assistant hears the matched 30 seconds.
- Pauses for recordings, Low Power Mode and heat; Settings with a notice.

LEFT OUT FOR NOW

- DigUp's own panel, hotkey, updater and model downloader.
- Code search.
- Search by meaning for external agents: the CLI and MCP search Files by words only.

Try it. Settings → Personal Context → Files → *Search my files*, then *Add Folder…* for Documents, Downloads or a photo folder; Settings shows each pass as it runs. In Ask, type what you are looking for: files follow meetings and screen moments, and *Sources* → *Result type* → *Files* shows only files. Quick Recall lists them under Files. Ask a question, and the assistant searches them too and cites the file it used.

INDEXING

One indexing pass, step by step

A pass runs at launch, when the folder list changes, and five seconds after something in the folders changes. It reads only what is new or changed, and the image model loads only when there is something to read.

1. **Trigger** — `launch · folders · FSEvents + 5 s`
   Changes inside hidden folders are ignored. A burst of changes becomes one pass.

2. **Should it wait?** — `checked before each batch`
   A meeting is recording, Low Power Mode is on, or the Mac is hot (thermal state serious or critical). Then it waits, and starts again when that ends. On battery, a folder's first read waits for a charger; up to 50 new files are read anyway.

3. **Sync** — `CPU · no model`
   DigUp walks the folders and compares sizes and dates with the index: new and changed files are queued, moved files keep their vectors, deleted files and folders taken off the list leave the index.

   > **Nothing new?** The pass ends here. An unchanged library never loads the image model.

4. **Prepare the model** — `first time only`
   Downloads the 555 MB projector (and the 310 MB text model, if search by meaning never ran), each checked against its pinned size and SHA-256.

5. **Start the media server** — `≈ 1 s · 873 MiB`
   A llama-server on port 17876, held in memory for the pass.

6. **Read and embed** — `CPU reads · GPU embeds`
   Screenshots first, then pictures, PDFs, documents, recordings and video, newest first. While the GPU embeds one file, a CPU thread decodes, OCRs or extracts the next. Long PDFs get their first 30 pages now. While you use the Mac it rests twice as long as each batch took; two minutes idle, it runs flat out.

7. **Finish long files** — `30 pages · 40 chunks a step`
   The rest of PDFs over 50 pages and of long documents, once everything else is searchable.

8. **Let go** — `2 min · 10 min`
   The media server stops two minutes after the pass. Search vectors leave memory after ten minutes without a search.

WHAT ONE FILE BECOMES

KIND	READ WITH	VECTORS
Screenshot	ImageIO; Vision OCR for exact words	1 image · 280 tokens
Picture	ImageIO, EXIF date	1 image · 140 tokens
PDF page	PDFKit text, up to 4,000 characters	1 text per page
Scanned page	rendered page; OCR words	1 image · 280 tokens
Document	Cocoa text, ~1,800-character chunks	1 text per chunk
Recording	30 s of sound, a new window every 25 s; silence skipped	1 audio per window
Video	a frame per shot, at most one every 3 s, plus its sound	1 image per frame · 70 tokens

NEVER READ

- Hidden files and folders, `~/Library`, app bundles, Photos libraries.
- Caches: `CACHEDIR.TAG`, `node_modules`, `DerivedData`, `.noindex`.
- Inside code projects, everything but screenshots.
- Folders that look like datasets (300+ machine-named media files).
- iCloud files that are only in the cloud: never downloaded.
- Pictures under 256 px, links, copy-protected audio.

Outages don't cost files. If the media server stops answering, DigUp ends the pass and keeps the files queued for the next one. Only a file that can't be read, like a broken picture, is marked failed, and it is read again when it changes.

COMPUTE ON YOUR MAC

How much your M4 Max works for it

Measured on this MacBook (M4 Max, 48 GB, on AC power) with the app's own llama-server and settings. Model time runs on the GPU; reading files runs on a CPU thread at the same time.

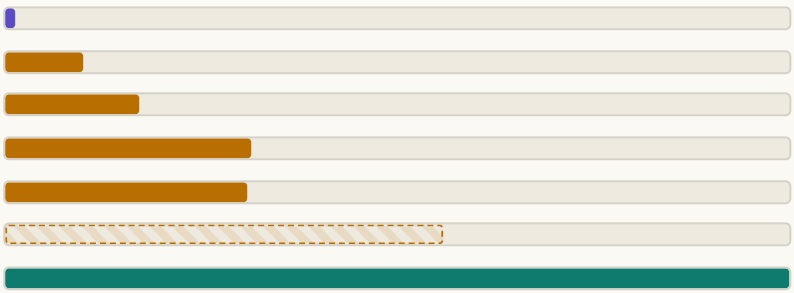
0 B
sent off this Mac by indexing or searching.

555 MB
one download, the first time: the image and audio projector.

873 MiB
while a pass runs (peak 1,002). Gone 2 minutes after it.

≈ 6 ms
to embed a search, on the text server that already runs.

MODEL TIME PER ITEM · P50



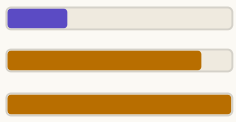
Striped: for comparison. Sizing each image for its token budget is what took a screenshot from 574 tokens and 247 ms (13 October run) to 277 tokens and 139 ms. One image per request; batching eight saved nothing.

FIRST PASS · MODEL TIME

FOLDER HOLDS	GPU TIME
2,000 screenshots	≈ 4.6 min
10,000 photos	≈ 13 min
5,000 PDF pages of text	≈ 2–3 min
An hour of video	≈ 72 s
An hour of recordings	≈ 20 s
A day's 20 new screenshots	≈ 3 s
A day of screen captures (≈ 490)	≈ 70 s
Nothing changed	0 s

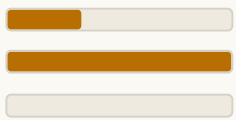
From the per-item times above; PDF pages from text throughput (≈ 14 ms per 1,500 characters). Reading runs on the CPU at the same time. DigUp measures Vision OCR at about 0.24 s per Retina screenshot, so for screenshots, reading rather than the GPU sets the pace.

MEMORY · FOOTPRINT



The text server is the one search by meaning already keeps. The media server exists only during a pass and counts against LokalBot's model memory budget, so it can't push out a model you are using. Search vectors take 1.5 KB each, loaded on the first search and freed after ten idle minutes: 20,000 pages and pictures are about 30 MB.

PACING · A BIG READ



After each batch it rests twice as long as the batch took (at most 20 s) while the next file is decoded. 10,000 photos: ≈ 13 min while you're away, ≈ 40 min while you work. On battery, up to 50 new files are still read; the rest waits unless you turn on reading on battery.

When it runs. Only during a pass, and only for files that are new or changed. Adding a folder first shows its time and index size on this Mac. While you work, a big read gets a third of the time (the times above, tripled); idle, it runs at full speed; on battery it waits for a charger. A recording, Low Power Mode or heat stops it after the files in hand. A search costs one 6 ms embedding plus a scan of the vectors in memory.

QUALITY AND BOUNDARIES

Why the results can be trusted

The vectors match DigUp's measured pipeline, the ranking is the one DigUp tested, and the feature has the same boundaries as LokalBot's other sources.

SAME VECTORS AS DIGUP · COSINE TO ITS REFERENCE

INPUT	TOKENS	COSINE
Texts (English, Bengali, Arabic, 1,800-token document)	–	**≥ 0.999999**
Screenshot (PNG), budget 280	277	**1.000000**
Speech (WAV)	104	**1.000000**
Photo (JPEG), budget 140	134	**0.99964**
Photo as video frame, budget 70	67	**0.99860**
Screenshot, llama.cpp's own sizing	574	0.98981
Photo, llama.cpp's own sizing	340	0.97075

Through the app's Swift path and a live media server (`FileMediaEmbedderReferenceTests`). JPEG inputs sit just under 1.0 only because macOS decodes JPEG with ImageIO and DigUp's reference with stb_image; fed the same pixels, the paths agree exactly.

RANKING

Each search scores every vector, then centres the scores within each modality, because text scores higher than pictures for the same topic. A file counts when it stands out by meaning ($z \geq 2$) or holds at least half the query's words; exact words add a bonus, so invoice numbers and names win. On DigUp's evals this found the right file first 88% of the time, against 73% with reciprocal-rank fusion, the method LokalBot uses for screens today (synthetic eval; 86% against 82% on real files).

TESTS IN THIS PULL REQUEST

- `FileSearchServiceTests`: DigUp's real crawler, readers and index.
- `FileMediaEmbedderTests`: request shapes, outages, broken files.
- `FileImageSizingTests`: DigUp's Pillow fixtures, bit for bit.
- `FileSearchAskTests`: source, tool, citations, evidence.
- `FileMediaEmbedderReferenceTests`: the live-server check above.
- `FileMomentTranscriberTests`: 30-second clips, transcribed once.

PRIVACY BOUNDARIES

- Off until you turn it on after a notice; nothing is read until you choose a folder.
- Reads only the listed folders; never changes, moves or uploads a file.
- Turning Files off deletes the whole index at once.
- A remote Think model sees file passages only when you ask with Files selected, and only at an origin you approved.
- External agents (CLI, MCP) search Files by words only, and only while Files is ticked under Settings → Privacy → External agents.

WHAT COMES NEXT

- **Check screens on your library.** Rerun the 13 October benchmark with the new ranking, the 280 budget and short literal queries.
- **A helper process** for indexing, so a runaway PDF can be stopped without touching the app.

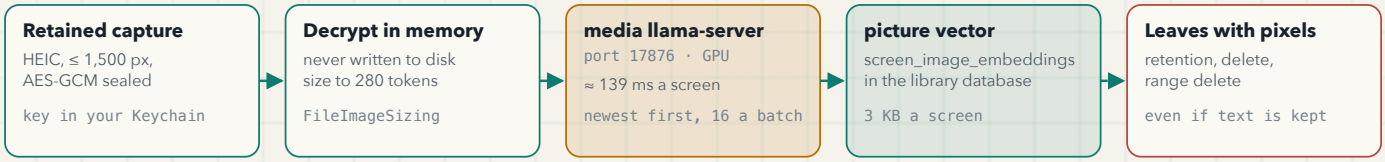
WHERE IT LIVES

`LokalBot/Services/FileSearch/ FileSearchService · FileSearchWorkers · FileMediaEmbedder · FileMediaEmbedderRuntime · FileImageSizing`
`LokalBot/Views/ FileSearchSettings · FileSearchResultRow (PDF opener) · AskView · QuickRecallView · ChatView (citations)`
`LokalBot/Models/ AskRouting (source, result type, tool scope) · RecallWorkspaceState (search)`
`LokalBot/Services/Chat/ MeetingChatTools (search_files) · ChatCitation ([file:ID]) · ChatAgent (prompt)`
`LlamaServerRole.mediaEmbedder (17876) · project.yml: DigUp at dc2651a · PRIVACY.md “Files you choose”`

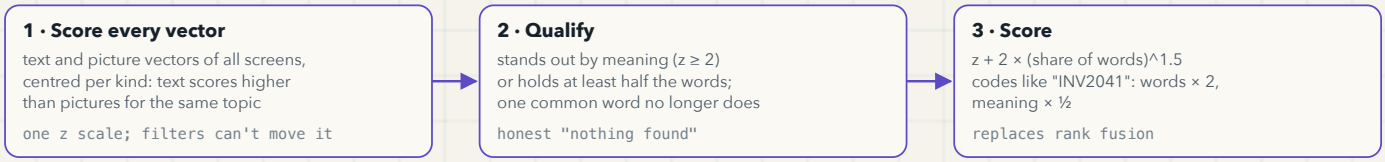
Screens by what they show

With Text + visual context and search by meaning on, each retained screenshot also gets a vector of its picture, and screen search ranks text and picture vectors with the query's words the way DigUp ranks files.

MAKING A PICTURE VECTOR · BATCHED, 15 MIN AFTER NEW CAPTURES



RANKING A SEARCH · ASK, QUICK RECALL, THE ASSISTANT'S search_screen



WHY PICTURES · YOUR LIBRARY, 13 OCTOBER

SCREEN SEARCH	FIRST	TOP 5
Picture vectors	**71 / 138**	**107**
Screen-text vectors	52	84
Shipped: words + text, rank fusion	**44**	**76**

505 real screens, queries written by a different model from the pixels (content in English and Serbian, appearance in English). Picture vectors won for every kind of query. Fusion scored below text alone because the OR-fallback word list weighed as much as meaning; the new ranking removes that. This exact combination has not been rerun on your library yet.

COMPUTE AND STORAGE

- **≈ 70 s of GPU a day** for about 490 captures, in passes 15 minutes after new captures.
- **≈ 21 MB** of picture vectors for 14 days of captures (3 KB each).
- **Searching** adds one dot product per retained screen; the query vector is the one the text server already made.
- **Starts** only after your first search of screens by meaning, which is when the 555 MB projector downloads if Files hasn't already.
- **Waits** while a meeting records, in Low Power Mode, and while the Mac is hot; paced while you work, and on battery only the newest 48 captures a pass.

Where it shows. Screen moments found by their picture appear in Ask and Quick Recall marked "Related by meaning", with their window title when they have no text. The assistant's `search_screen` uses the same ranking, so it can answer "the dashboard with the red chart" even when no word on screen says so.